

Bhavana Akilan

Early-Stage Investing | AI and Emerging Technology | Venture Research and Sourcing

bhav.akilan@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/bhavana-akilan](https://www.linkedin.com/in/bhavana-akilan) | +1 (647) - 891 0578

Education

University of Toronto

2021-2025

Honours Bachelor of Science - Life Sciences, Major, Neuroscience

Double Minors, Psychology and Health Humanities

UofT International Scholar | Laidlaw Scholar | Women-in-Leadership Fellow | Dean's Circle | Dean's List x3

Work Experience

StrategyRx | Strategy and Operations Associate

March 2026 — Present

Toronto | Contract Part-Time

- Contributing to strategic advisory work for early-stage digital health companies, developing market sizing frameworks, competitive landscape analysis, and investment-adjacent recommendations that inform client decision-making
- Supporting development of the Clinical Feasibility Framework, the firm's core proprietary methodology for assessing healthcare technology adoption readiness across clinical, operational, and strategic dimensions
- Conducted outreach and research across 130+ prospect healthcare startups and organisations, building the analytical foundation for the firm's pipeline development

Stealth AI Startup (a16z) | QA Analyst, Spatial Intelligence

June 2026 — Present

Toronto (Remote) | Contract Part-Time

- Embedded inside an early-stage AI startup building world model technology, developing hands-on understanding of how spatial intelligence systems are built, evaluated, and iterated, gaining direct exposure to the AI infrastructure layer from the inside
- Completing 500+ quality assessments weekly, identifying edge cases and systemic issues that directly shape the product's development trajectory and inform the research team's priorities
- Operating at the frontier of one of the most heavily funded areas in AI, world models and spatial intelligence, with direct insight into the operational and technical challenges that institutional investors are tracking

COCO PR Agency and Communications | Marketing & PR Strategist

August 2025 — April 2026

Singapore (Remote) | Contract Full-Time

- Managed strategic relationships across 10 concurrent client accounts in Southeast Asia, serving as the primary advisor translating business objectives into market positioning and measurable outcomes, developing the client relationship and account management skills central to portfolio support work
- Secured 500+ KOL placements across top-tier UK and Singapore media, building and maintaining a proprietary network of 200+ industry operators and thought leaders through targeted outreach and relationship development
- Built reporting infrastructure from scratch across all accounts, enabling real-time performance visibility and delivering structured recommendations adopted into client planning cycles

Project Experience

Society for Innovation at the Intersection of Nat. & Art. Intelligence

May 2024 — April 2025

University of Toronto

- Founded Toronto's first interdisciplinary AI and neuroscience community from zero to 200+ members in under 3 months, identifying a gap in the ecosystem, executing a cold outreach strategy, and building a high-calibre network of researchers, founders, and operators without institutional backing
- Coordinated 10 speakers and 3 sponsors for the flagship technology conference, was subsequently headhunted to co-host a Women in Engineering conference at Toronto Tech Week, signalling credibility within the Toronto technology ecosystem

Skills

Venture and Investment: Thematic research • Sector mapping • Competitive landscape analysis • Investment thesis development • Deal sourcing • Founder relationship building • Market sizing

Research and Analysis: Evidence synthesis • Quantitative and qualitative analysis • Academic literature review • Primary research • Data-driven insights • Structured recommendation development

AI and Technology: World model technology • Spatial intelligence • Agentic AI • Generative AI • Applied machine learning • AI strategy • Claude • Python • R

Tools: Excel • PowerPoint • Airtable • Notion • Asana • SQL • Slack • MS Teams • Zoom